

נָשָׂא *to take wives* 1, 4 (for the usual 'לָקַח נ', as 2 Ch. 11, 21. 13, 21. 24, 3. Ezr. 9, 2. 12. 10, 44. Neh. 13, 25 (in Jud. 21, 23 rather differently = *to carry away, secure*; Budde, *Richter und Samuel*, p. 154).

עָנָן *to restrain* 1, 13 (as *perhaps* in Aram.: but comp. Payne Smith, *s.v.*).

שָׁבַר *to hope* 1, 13, as Is. 38, 18 (poet.). Ps. 104, 27. 119, 166. 145, 15.

Est. 9, 1† (= Aram. סָבַר) : cf. subst. שָׁבַר Ps. 119, 116. 146, 5† (late).

יְרֵי *Almighty* 1, 20 f. (without אֱלֹהִים *God*: p. 119, *note*), as never elsewhere in prose, and in poetry chiefly in Job.

מִרְגְּלוֹת *the parts about the feet* 3, 4. 7. 8. 14, only besides Dan. 10, 6.

לָפַת *to turn about* 3, 8, only besides Job 6, 18 (but Arab., not Aram.).

קִים *to confirm* 4, 7, as Ez. 13, 6. Ps. 119, 28. 106. Est. 9, 21. 27. 29. 31.

32, and in Aram. (Dan. 6, 8)†.¹

Of these קִים cannot be defended as old-Hebrew; but the word occurs in a verse which is not needed in the narrative, and has every appearance of being an *explanatory gloss* (cf. the gloss in 1 Sa. 9, 9, *which begins similarly*).

Of the others, מִרְגְּלוֹת is formed in exact analogy with מִרְאִשׁוֹת (1 Sa. &c.); its not occurring elsewhere till Dan. may be due merely to its not being required. שָׁרִי (which occurs in poetry in Nu. 24, 4. 16) may be a poetical term (cf. 2, 12^b) chosen intentionally by the author: poetical expressions occur from time to time in other pre-exilic historical books. In reference to the rest, it may be remembered that words, with Aramaic or late Hebrew affinities, occur, at least sporadically, in passages admittedly of early date (as תְּשׁוּרָה, אֹזֶל in 1 Sa. 9, 1—10, 16). לָהֵן is the word which it is most difficult to reconcile with an early date; but it is possible that the Book, in spite of its interest in Bethlehem and David, was yet written in the N. kingdom, and preserves words current there dialectically (p. 422).

It seems to the writer that the general beauty and purity of the style of Ruth point more decidedly to the pre-exilic period than do the isolated expressions quoted to the period after the exile.² The genealogy, 4, 18—22, which also appears to suggest an exilic or post-exilic date (הוֹלִיד [p. 127, No. 45]; and comp. 1 Ch. 2, 9 ff.), forms no integral part of the Book, and may well have been added long after the Book itself was written, in an age that was devoted to the study of pedigrees, in order to supply the missing links between Boaz and Perez (4, 12).

That David had Moabite connexions is probable independently from 1 Sa. 22, 3 f. The basis of the narrative consists, it may reasonably be supposed, of the family traditions respecting Ruth

¹ צִבְטָ (2, 14) is wrongly cited as an Aramaism. It is pure Hebrew = Arab. ضَبَطَ = Aram. ضَبَطَ (*Tenses*, § 178. 1). Nor is צִבְטָ (2, 16) an Aramaic word

² But, it is true, the style of the prose parts of *Job* (p. 405) is not less pure.